

Setting the scene

Romeo and Juliet is one of Shakespeare's tragedies. The couple can never be together because their families hate each other.

These are the first words Romeo ever says to Juliet.

ROMEO (to Juliet, touching her hand)
If I profane with my unworthiest hand
This holy shrine, the gentle sin is this:
My lips, two blushing pilgrims,
ready stand
To smooth that rough touch with a
tender kiss.

95

Juliet replies—she is not upset at him holding her hand.

JULIET
Good pilgrim, you do wrong your hand
too much,
Which mannerly devotion shows in this;
For saints have hands that pilgrims'
hands do touch,

This line is not spoken—it tells the actors what to do.

There are 145 lines in this scene, or part of the play. This is line 95.

Makeup magic

To make an audience believe what they are seeing, players often change the way they look by using makeup.



Young



Going grey

Talcum powder and special white mascara makes brown hair and eyebrows look gray.



Old

Pale powder takes away the rosy cheeks.

Lines are drawn on the face with a special dark pencil.

The actress pretends to be shy, yet pleased to receive the rose.



Staged in the East

Spectacular traditional Chinese plays are known as Peking opera in the West. Every action and color has a special meaning—the costume and makeup color show the sort of person the actor is playing.

